

Indexicality
(Annotated Bibliography)

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Indexicality

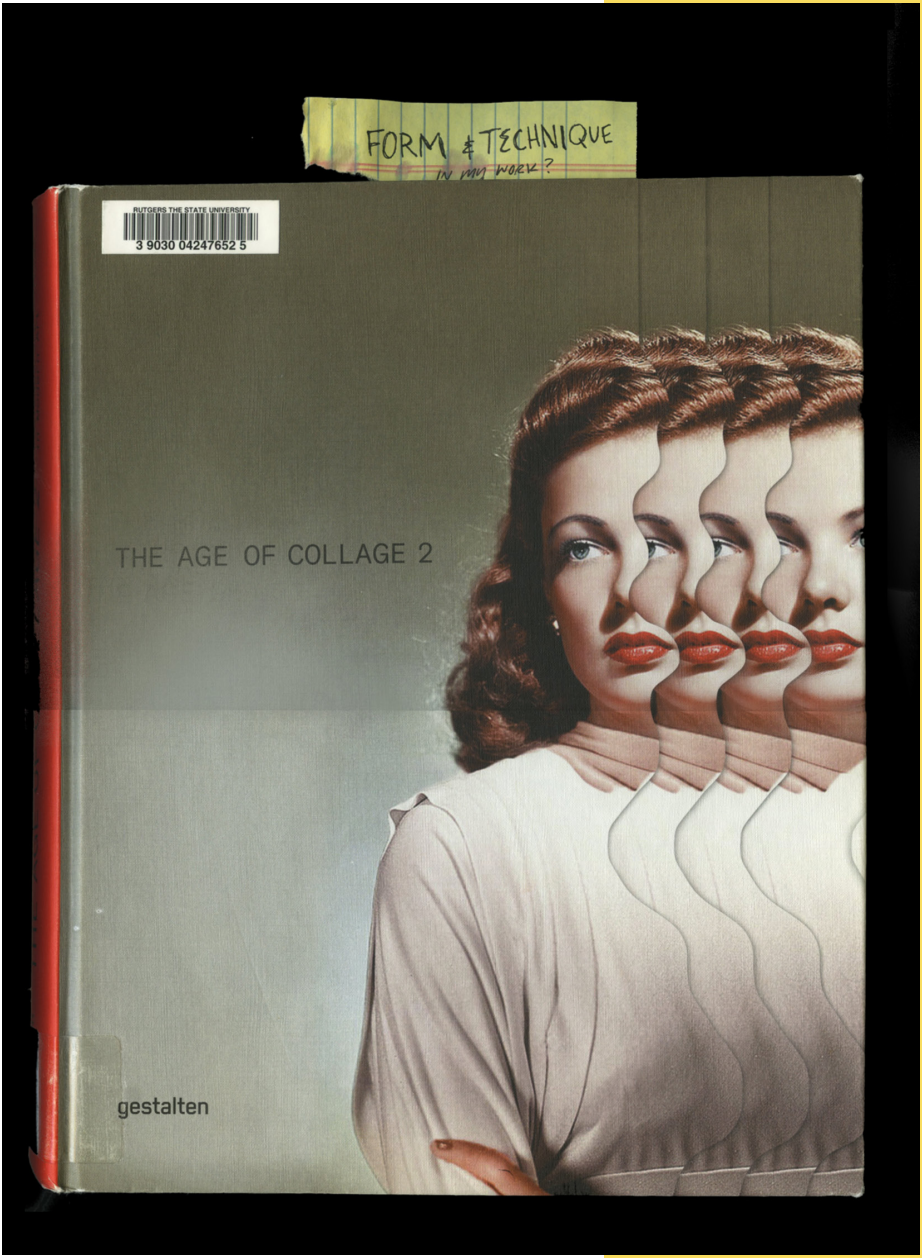
Intro

My thesis project aims to explore memory and personal archive through a series of collages. The aim is to document memories by making them harder to parse out than the photos I would be using for reference because that is how memories feel to me. I want them to feel more accurate to the actual action of recalling. By using ink and collage, that sense of recall will be more apparent—along with a concrete description of each piece that allows the viewer to understand the context of each one. In doing so, I hope to grow in my abilities to work fast and instinctively by creating connections between memories without overthinking.

The research I conducted focused on technique and application, display, artist inspiration, and themes of archive.

FORM & TECHNIQUE
IN MY WORK?

RUTGERS THE STATE UNIVERSITY
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COLLECTING ECHOES:
The Poetic Power Of Collage

Subversion is at the core of collage. Collecting images, stripping them of their initial context, and pasting them into new compositions is an act of subversion, sometimes even a subtle yet bold form of protest. This is not only true of overtly political pieces like those of John Heartfield, which explicitly ridiculed the Nazi party and its ideologies in the 1930s by, for instance, depicting an X-ray photograph of Hitler's upper body containing a stomach full of gold and a swastika in place of a heart. It is true as well of collage works that simply feature fragments from the artist's everyday surroundings in unexpected arrangements, since imposing new meaning onto materials often intended for mass

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the way we understand artistic repr
sentation; and after the Futurists had
used collage as a way of illustrating

and propagating the
manifestos that cal
pre-industrial pas
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Dadaists and Surre
ed the medium. The
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RICHARD KRAFT 311

LAURINDO FELICIANO

Laurindo Feliciano's collages are motivated by the interpretation of memory. He explains, "The focus of my work is to capture and to translate the maze of collective memories that have faded or become vague, gaining new value as they age. Spiritualism, philosophy, and literature references are common elements in my illustrations. My style has changed a lot since I started. My first collage works used to follow this strong notion behind the accumulation of elements, but now my focus is to go against this assumption to try and create compositions that are more homogeneous as a whole—almost as if I were trying to make an anti-collage using collage techniques." The Brazilian-born, France-based artist also credits his home country with being a great influence: "The chaotic way the cities are constructed in most Latin American countries looks like a big urban collage with tons of textures provided by self-built architecture, handmade advertising, graffiti, etc. All those urban elements can be found to a certain degree in the development of my collage work."

SIMILAR, BUT W/ PERSONAL MEMORY



1)

THE AGE OF COLLAGE Vol.2

Contemporary Collage in Mod

This book was conceived, edited, and designed by GESTALTEN.

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UNCLEAR WHO WROTE WHAT, TBH. WHEN I LOOK IT UP, JUST THE TOP 2 GUYS SHOW UP— BUSCH & KLANTEN— AS THE AUTHORS, BUT THE PREFACE & ARTIST PROFILES ARE LITERALLY WHAT THE WRITING OF THIS BOOK IS, SO THAT SEEMS A BIT FUCKED THAT HOBEIKA IS GETTING SHAFTED LIKE THAT IN THE GOOGLE SEARCH. THE 2 DUDES SEEM QUALIFIED ENOUGH (BUSCH IS A COLLAGE ARTIST, WHO MIGHT HAVE DONE A FEW IN THE MIDDLE OF THE BOOK THAT ARE UNLABELED? IT'S KIND OF UNCLEAR, WHILE KLANTEN IS AN AUTHOR/FOUNDER OF GESTALTEN, THE PUBLISHING COMPANY FOR THIS BOOK THAT SEEMS WELL-ESTABLISHED/RESPECTED).

SO NOT AN AUTHOR, EVEN THOUGH GOOGLE LABELED HIM AS SUCH, SO IT

NOELIA HOBEIKA APPEARS TO BE "AN ABSTRACT PAINTER WHOSE WORK CENTERS ON MATERIAL NUANCE & COMPOSITIONAL RESTRAINT." → ACCORDING TO HER WEBSITE. BC THIS WAS PUBLISHED NEARLY 10 YEARS AGO, HER CURRENT WORK DOESN'T SEEM TO FULLY ALIGN W/ THIS WORK OF COLLAGE, BUT BETWEEN 2014-2018 SHE WAS A COLLAGE ARTIST, SO HER OPINION AS AN ARTIST IN THAT MEDIUM SEEMS VALID. IN ANY EVENT, IT @ LEAST HELPED ME UNDERSTAND ABOUT MY WORK IN RELATION~~SHIP~~ TO THE MEDIUM OF COLLAGE, SO THAT'S SOMETHING, EVEN IF SHE ISN'T USUALLY AN ARTIST WRITER

veral years before using a safely guard-
e. They also tend to be sensitive to
bity and consider the happenstance of
g onto material a driving factor for
n. Some even think of collage not as
g that they make happen, but as some-
thing that happens to them—a way of relating
to the medium that embraces the visceral and
psychical, showing once again the Surrealists'
enduring influence.

Collage is often said to be the medium of the twentieth century—and so far that of the twenty-first century too—because the appropriating, cutting, pasting, and remixing that are at its root have become pervasive in countless fields, like in music where sampling is now a ubiquitously widespread technique. The digital sphere, as an infinite source of material and a platform for new methods that were previously out of reach, has contributed to collage's proliferation as well, yet what truly makes collage the medium of our epoch is the fact that it reflects and responds to some of modern life's key issues and phenomena. Excess is one of our time's most pressing concerns, as exemplified by insatiable consumerism and unmanageable amounts of waste, so collage's recycling and repurposing of imagery in a world that is also visually saturated is particularly meaningful. Collage can also be understood as mirroring the patchwork experience of globalization, through which elements that carry differing—sometimes even opposing—histories are brought together in a layering of cultures.

The growing relevance of the medium can be further witnessed through the prominent position it now holds in contemporary visual culture. Collage is in high demand among illustrators, who are frequently commissioned eate works for a variety of purposes in- g book covers, concert posters, and high profile magazines. In turn, photographers are experimenting with what can be described as a three-dimensional extension of collage in the form of the photographic still life, a composition increasingly used for vanguard editorial features and advertisements. Collage has seeped into our visual language, and part of its potency stems

THIS TEXT ISN'T MUCH OF A TEXT ON COLLAGE, MORE THAN IT IS ~~AN ACCOMPLICE~~ A COLLECTION of COLLAGE EXAMPLES w/ DESCRIPTIONS of the ARTIST SHOWN—HOWEVER, I think THIS INTRO DESERVES the HISTORY of COLLAGE & ITS USE IN CONTEMPORARY ART IS IMPORTANT FOR UNDERSTANDING MY PRACTICE. FROM THE SURREALISTS & DADAISTS TO THE ERA of NOW, COLLAGE HAS BEEN USED IN ART TO SUBVERT & SHOCK VIEWERS. IT DEMONSTRATES MORE THAN REAL LIFE (SURREALISM) BY (usually) USING REAL-LIFE imagery & PHOTOS. IT SUBVERTS (SURREALISM) w/ JUXTAPOSITIONS & INVERSIONS, COMMENTING ON THINGS FROM POLITICS TO DESCRIBING THEIR IDEAS IN A ~~THE~~ WAY that IS MORE ASSOCIATIVE IN THEIR CREATION. TYPICALLY, the MATERIAL for COLLAGE is SOURCED FROM other PLACES, GIVING the ARTIST PRE-EXISTING IMAGES TO WORK FROM, GIVING them both a RESTRAINT & FREEDOM to NOT PRODUCE THEIR OWN FOUNDATION from SCRATCH.

PERSONAL REFLECTION on the TEXT?
- THIS MADE ME think about my ART IN RELATION to the GREATER PANTHEON of COLLAGE ARTISTS BC MOST of them use photographs while I used DRAWINGS based on PHOTOGRAPHS
  - ↳ I COLLAGE the IMAGES bc that's how it FEELS to TRY & RECALL that MOMENT THEN THEY'RE COBBLED together COLLAGE-LIKE bc that FEELS LIKE TRYING TO PARSE them
- MAYBE I CAN PLAY w/ JUXTAPOSITION MORE

@ LOOK at the DRAWINGS IN THIS TEXT

THE PICTURES USED DON'T NEED TO BE EXACT— THEY SHOULD

* UNCANNINESS

In essence, the subversion of collage also lies in its never-ending ability to surprise: contemporary collage continues to push the boundaries of a medium that holds such power in its poetry and poetry in its power.

FOCUS: ART & ARCHIVES

Art & Archives Part 1, Archive as Art

VINCE DZIEKAN

The wellspring of new thinking initiated by the *archival turn* of the 1990s has been sustained as an ongoing challenge to the relationship between **Art and Archives**; not just with regards to a critique of the role that archives are seen as playing in public culture today, but in the more provocative and increasingly urgent ways that artists and other institutional "outsiders" are revealing alternative understandings about the natures, meanings and uses of their collections (i.e. What is collected, by whom and for what ends). The underlying basis of what archive scholar Eric Ketelaar has identified as the "first" *archival turn* drew its inspiration from the multi-disciplinary perspectives that non-archivists brought to "the archive"; notably, amongst those being anthropologists, sociologists, philosophers, cultural and literary theorists, curators... and artists. In the process, fresh, new conceptualizations that extend beyond providing institutionalized accounts of an artist's career, charting their artistic legacy or documenting the provenance of artworks were advanced that have motivated a paradigmatic shift in thinking: from viewing archives as sources to seeing them as subjects in their own right; in short, approaching '*archiving* as process rather than *archives* as things' (Ketelaar, 2017, 232; Emphasis added). Through exploring the reciprocal means by which art might engage with archives – and archives, in art – and by embracing the proce ated with archiving and record creative, performative acts, which kind of duality that Anthony G identified as operating within arc tures, wherein 'the structured p social systems are simultaneously and outcome of social acts' (Gid 19), this focus section hopes to this rich vein of discourse by *retu* subject with renewed effort to recent developments in open h cultural informatics.

In overly reductive terms, recordkeeping processes are called documents and preserve them as However, motivated by a *continu* approach[1], the onus placed on archiv tation and description has moved b cataloguing of fixed records to a muc grative system capable of taking ac multiple interrelationships, shifting overlaps that occur across space between documents, people and pr mulated by Australian academic Fr (and developed upon subsequently b affiliated with the Records Continu Group at Monash University, in McKemmish, Livia Iacovino and Ba the Records Continuum Model has nificant contribution to critical thi

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2 April 2020

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king in the

nash Art
m Journal.

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also listed down here, which I didn't notice @ 1st.

[That's a lot of acronyms!]

(ACCORDING TO MONASH.EDU)

"VINCE DZIEKAN (PHD, MONASH; MA, MONASH; GRADDIP EDUC, HAWTHORN INSTITUTE; DIP FA, ECAD, UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE; DIP FA, ECAD, CANADA) IS A SENIOR ACADEMIC & PRACTITIONER-RESEARCHER AT MONASH UNIVERSITY, AUSTRALIA, AND RESEARCH FELLOW WITH THE INSTITUTE FOR DIGITAL CULTURE (UNIVERSITY OF TASMANIA)." & THEN IT GIVES ONTO ALL OF HIS RESEARCH/AWARDS & PRIZES FOR FINE ART. ACCORDING TO THE LITTLE SCHMEARDING DESCRIBING HIS JOB IN THE GOOGLE PROFILE THING THAT ALL PEOPLE OF NOTE HAVE, HE'S ALSO AN EXHIBITIONS CURATOR, & HAS DONE MANY TALKS ON MUSEUMS/DIGITAL ARCHIVE. OVERALL, YEAH I'D TRUST THIS GUY TO WRITE ABOUT ART & ARCHIVES.

Google
Q. Vince Dziekan

& he's got ONE of those things he's gotta be pretty important

CONCEPT/DISPLAY of my Art.



PERSONAL REFLECTION ON the TEXT?

- MORE about ARCHIVES of ART than ART that ARCHIVES, which is what my ART is about
- BUT!! this makes me want to dive in MORE INTO that INVERSE where I play MORE w/ existing archives*
- STILL IMPORTANT TO THINK about how PIECES of the ARCHIVE CONNECT to one ANOTHER, bc I think that's one of the MAIN things I need to tighten up on, so Reading about ARCHIVES that do that is INSPIRING & helpful

* the archive I use IN MY PRACTICE is my own photos/experiences

practice. Published in two parts, this first collection of articles has been grouped here under the over-arching rubric, 'Archive-as-Art'; whereas, the set of texts that follow in a separate issue have been guided by the thematic, 'Art-as-Archive'. Together, the multiple and multi-facetted perspectives shared by this community of authors – artists and archivists; theorists and practitioner-researchers alike – embody the rich, reciprocal influences that *continue* to characterise the shared subject of art and archives. END

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~~Intro~~

This text goes into how the idea of the Archive has evolved over the years. In its basic form, "archive and Recordkeeping processes are called upon to 'fix' documents and preserve them as 'evidence', but Dziekan then goes into how archivist roles beyond just cataloguing & is also "taking account of the multiple interrelationships, shifting contexts and overlaps that occur across space and time between documents, people, and processes."

[sic] (this was NO oxford comma originally)

Thinking of Archives as a more layered approach, in a way. This is mostly about Archives of Art, such as museums & Libraries, & how they are open for community collaboration, especially in the digital age. Art needs to be recorded & preserved, & these institutions that do that protected.

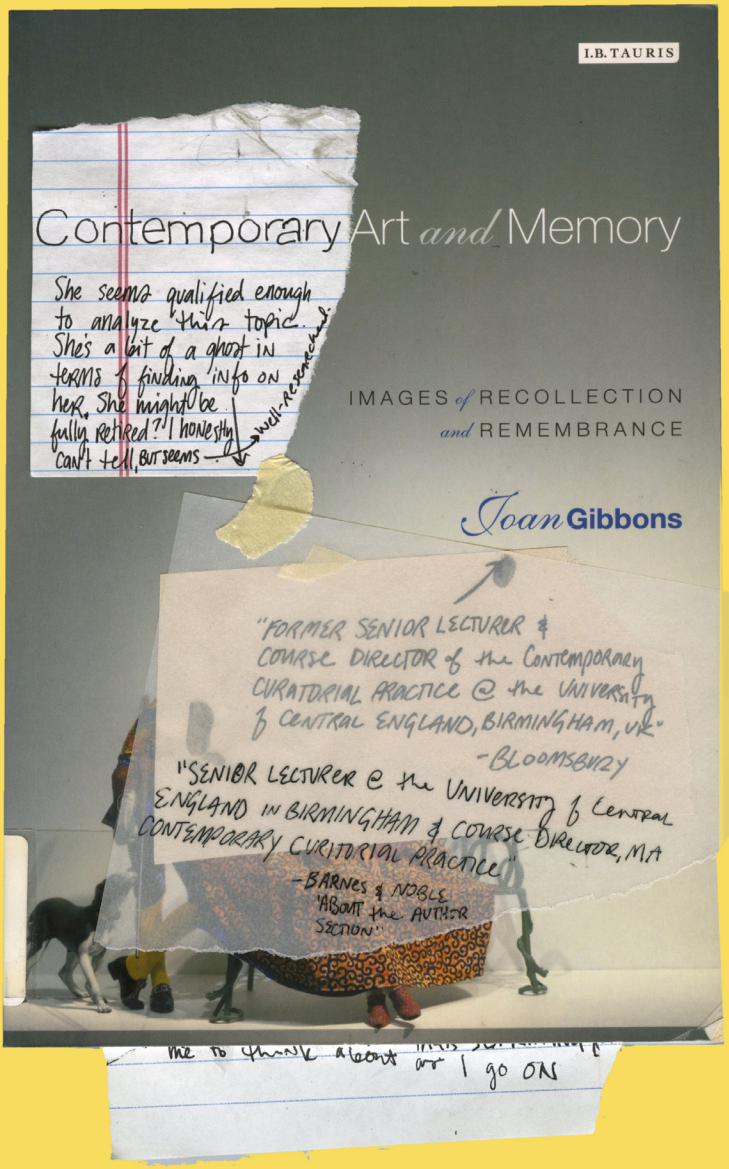
of *turning* themselves inside out by inviting their audiences and users in to "hack" and remix culture. Across the sector, museums, libraries and archives are facilitating community-led programming, hosting hackathons and experimental crowd-sourcing projects, and enabling amateur and academic researchers alike to explore their collections. However, it is important to acknowledge that alongside genuine efforts supporting greater cooperation with communities for mutual benefit is the attendant risk that such moves might end up assuming

with improving the we… of people and their communities through more effective uses of ICTs that promote positive change and transformative action in emergent social-technical relationships. Running counter to the forms of prediction and control exerted by the corporate monopolization of the media and Internet by powerful oligarchies[3], community-centric recordkeeping and archiving practices are concerned with empowering communities in the face of hyper-connectivity to support democratic principles and humanistic values associated with civil rights, self-determination, sustainable development, and social inclusion. From this perspective, cultural heritage-oriented applications of informatics have the potential to be employed in ways that bridge rather than exacerbate the digital divide by supporting community information gathering and sharing, self-knowledge and memory needs; thus, contributing to the building of more resilient communities and cultures. In numerous instances, artists find themselves at the vanguard of such important developments.

Since its founding…

…authorized to Wiley Online Library…

DOESN'T HAVE MUCH TO DO W/ MY PRACTICE, BUT NOW I WANT IT TO. SOMEHOW. (SUPPORT WIKIPEDIA & YOUR LOCAL LIBRARIES!!!)


I.B.TAURIS
Contemporary Art and Memory
IMAGES of RECOLLECTION and REMEMBRANCE
Joan Gibbons
She seems qualified enough to analyze this topic. She's a bit of a ghost in terms of finding info on her. She might be fully retired?! I honestly can't tell, but seems well-respected.
"FORMER SENIOR LECTURER & COURSE DIRECTOR of the CONTEMPORARY CURATORIAL PRACTICE @ the UNIVERSITY of CENTRAL ENGLAND, BIRMINGHAM, UK"
-BLOOMSBURY
"SENIOR LECTURER @ the UNIVERSITY of CENTRAL ENGLAND IN BIRMINGHAM & COURSE DIRECTOR, MA CONTEMPORARY CURATORIAL PRACTICE"
-BARNES & NOBLE "ABOUT the AUTHOR SECTION"

generates insight into the interweaving of personal memory within larger cultural schemes.

As Ankori suggests, the painting can be seen as an image of rebirth, a response to recent events that must have caused Kahlo to dwell on the idea and experiences of motherhood (a failed abortion, the adjustment to oncoming motherhood and a quickly ensuing readjustment to the miscarriage and the death of her own mother). On the other hand, Kahlo rejects any conventional image of mother and child, exposing the carnal reality of the female body, allowing Kahlo to rethink her identity as a woman.[16] However, despite this flouting of iconographic convention, the work takes a conventional form – that of a domestic retablo, a votive image that is used to give thanks for escape from disaster, usually accompanied by an inscription.[17] In this case, however, the inscription is conspicuously missing from the scroll at the bottom of the painting – a telling absence, given Kahlo's habit of inscribing the scrolls in her more conventional self-portraits. The reason for the absence of the inscription becomes obvious when it is remembered that the painting refers back to the miscarriage depicted in *The Henry Ford Hospital*, in which personal disaster had been neither avoided nor overcome. Moreover, the missing inscription can also be read as a sign of the unspeakability of trauma – the inability, as Cathy Caruth notes (after Freud), of being able to fully assimilate trauma as it occurs and the need to find belated and symptomatic or allusive ways of reviving the crisis in order to remember it.[18]

In works such as *My Birth*, the practice of self-portraiture shifts in a way that is to prefigure later approaches to autobiography in contemporary art and the ways in which it functions as memory. Given that Kahlo's self-portraits have begun a process in which the past is reworked as a means of understanding the self in its larger context, it is useful to introduce the idea of *Nachträglichkeit* (loosely translated here as 'retroactivity' or 'after-sight'). *Nachträglichkeit* is a psychical process mentioned by Sigmund Freud, whereby an original experience is reconstituted, retranscribed or rearranged in relation to ongoing circumstances – not only to replay the experience but to gather new meaning and endow it with a psychical effectiveness that has been lost by the repression of the experience.[19] As literary theorist Nicola King has recently shown, *Nachträglichkeit* forms an important [illegible] the formation of memory traces, and, as is clearly the case with *My Birth*, a painting can be forgotten or repressed, as it clearly was with Kahlo herself. As noted, the metaphor of excavation quickly establishes itself in Benjamin's thoughts on memory and history and the methods he used to chronicle his native city of Berlin. Here, memory is not an instrument for exploring the past but the medium through which that has been known or experienced has to be processed – the soil that has to be dug and turned

1

Autobiography: The Externalisation of Personal Memory

STARTING FROM the HISTORY of SELF-PORTRATURE w/ REMBRANDT, this text (OR CHAPTER, @ least) goes INTO HOW ARTISTS PORTRAY themselves. FROM more OBVIOUS self-PORTRAITS to something MORE SYMBOLIC LIKE FRIDA KAHLO'S PORTRAITS OR LOUISE BOURGEOIS' SCULPTURES. ~~CONTEMPORARY ART~~ THIS TYPE of ART EXTENDS beyond JUST PORTRAYING LIKE VISUALLY, IT TRIES TO CAPTURE the emotion attached to the memory/ experience being PORTRAYED. ~~Another~~ OTHER examples she goes INTO IS TRACEY EMIN, FELIX GONZALEZ-TORRES, & NAN GOLDIN. EVEN THOUGH their APPROACHES ARE all WILDLY DIFFERENT, they all DRAW FROM PERSONAL EXPERIENCES & WANT to CONVEY those experiences to the audience. Some, like GOLDIN, are more overt than others, like GONZALEZ-TORRES, BUT they are all effective IN SHOWING a REPRESENTATION of their memory IN AUTO-BIOGRAPHY.

PERSONAL REFLECTION ON the TEXT?

- NOTHING I DIDN'T already KNOW TBH, EXCEPT for maybe the TRACEY EMIN example
- REAFFIRM how I thought about autobiography IN ART
  - ↳ BUT some ARTISTS I DIDN'T REALLY THINK about that way before, LIKE GOLDIN OR GONZALEZ-TORRES, b/c I associate them w/ documenting PEOPLE IN their LIVES, but the accumulation of that sort of INDEX DOES add up to the ARTIST, all gestalt-like, which I hadn't really THOUGHT ABOUT UNTIL RIGHT this SECOND as I'M WRITING this, & that's pretty much exactly what I'm DOING w/ my piece, SO that's SOMETHING FOR me to think about as I go ON

2

Traces: Memory and Indexicality

In this chapter I want to explore works that anchor memory through an indexical relationship with the subject represented, works that almost literally 'trace off' the actual world. To do this, I begin with a discussion of the work of Rachel Whiteread, whose sculptures are essentially direct cast[s] taken from objects – or, better, the surfaces of objects that hold tra[ces] object's 'life' until being frozen in time by the casting proc[ess]. [W]orks, I argue, come as close as can be to a pure i[ndex]. [T]he most widely used medium in th[e] [re]lationship to its subj[ect]

ARTIST INSPIRATION?

The Art of Joseph Grigely

Deafness, Conversation, Noise

Susannah B. Mintz
Skidmore College in Saratoga Springs, New York

The article focuses on recent installation art, particularly large-scale pieces in paper collage and a recent video installation, by Joseph Grigely. It argues that Grigely's work stages dialogue between Deaf and hearing people as an embodied act that complicates ableist hierarchies, [illegible] first [illegible] emphasizing parts of the body other than the ear and second by suggesting [illegible] is thus reasserted as both inevitable and creatively [illegible] Disability [illegible] do with the [illegible] bodies and a discontinuous accumulation of thoughts that layer and inflect each other in nonlinear ways.

MEMORY* (IN MY CASE)

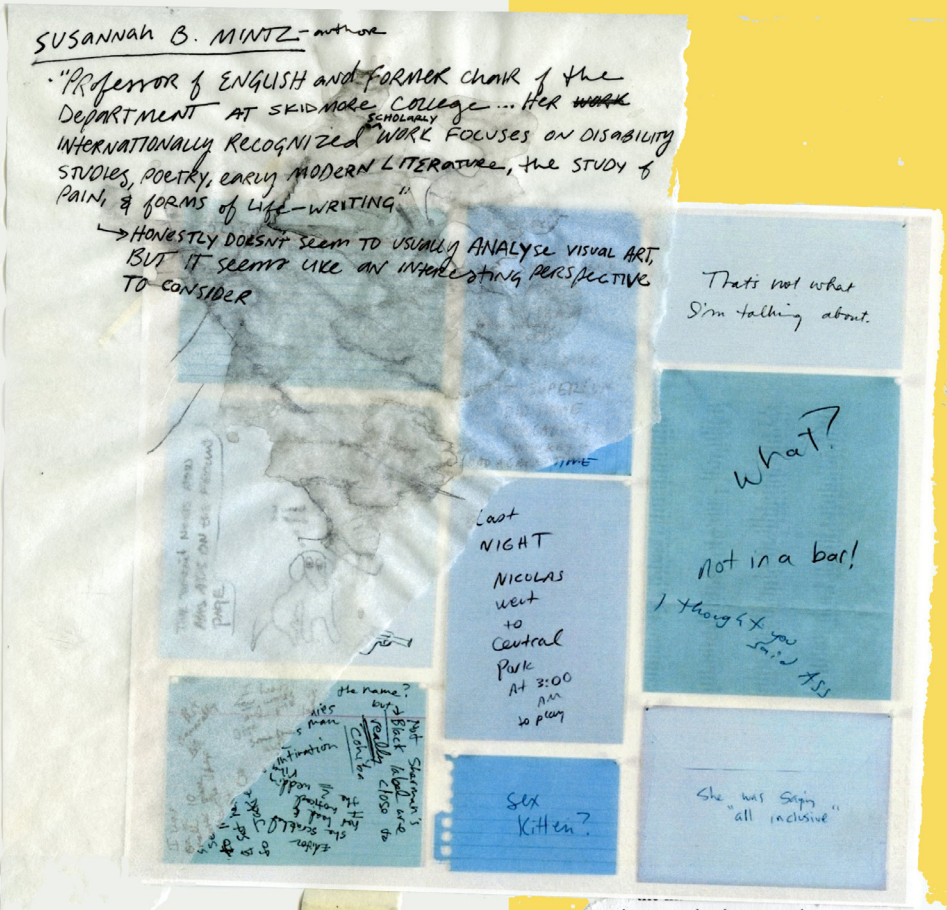
While his WORK IS OBVIOUSLY DIRECTLY RELATED TO his deafness, HIS APPROACH to DISPLAYING & ARCHIVING the PAST feels SIMILAR to MINE IN a way that feels like I'm almost echoing his WORK

Grigely's paper collages take one step further this principle that ~~dialogue~~ is inherently fractured as well as material. In these elaborate installations, Grigely arranges on a wall fragments of paper on which he has exchanged notes with hearing people. These "conversations" can be read in any direction, are thus endlessly variable, and so emphasize the playful, accidental properties of language: meaning happens by mistake; conversations are always a little bit out of our control; some form of residue will be left behind. The orderly grids of paper return language to dialogue in a way that might seem to elide the body completely. The graphic quality of these dialogues, however, keeps our attention trained on the bodies who produced them; the many different styles of writing alone remind us that these conversations were produced by distinct individuals: "the pen or pencil is connected to the hand," in Grigely's words (Interview, 19). At the same time, by materializing the *disorderliness* of ~~language~~—shattering the notion that conversation is a coherent act whose forward movement is directed by discrete, turn-taking, autonomous, hearing selves—the paper compilations refute both aurality and sequentiality as the indices of meaningful human communication. And it is precisely this disruption of wholeness, and the redirection of our attention away from ears and onto hands that write (or, as I explore later, faces that express), that aligns Grigely's conversation pieces with several core tenets of disability theory.

MEMORY* (IN MY CASE)

Focusing here on the paper collage work, a series of "conversation" installations, and a recent video piece, I want to explore the connections Grigely establishes between dialogue, representation, and disability. Because they make randomness the basis for art, and because they so consistently foreground error as the matrix of intersubjective exchange, Grigely's works challenge an aesthetic

*honestly just swap out any mention of LANGUAGE & CONVERSATION w/ 'memory' or 'recall' & that sort of PRACTICE then becomes essentially what I'm DOING



so be true: what hearing culture
comes here, with stark, dramatic
munication.

A work like "Whi
vokes us to reconsider not only what it means to converse, but also what it means to write a life. The installation depicts life story as splintered in the extreme; there is no continuous narrative, only shreds of paper, vestiges of thought and impulse, and a multiplicity of represented selves. This works to interrupt a humanist, ultimately ableist, definition of identity as whole, fully knowable and transcribable according to a recognized narrative arc. In the totality of excerpts, however (what Michael Davidson calls Grigely's "discursive flotsam"
to say, a viewer
or read

This text goes INTO Art & DISABILITY & how [redacted] Joseph GRIGELY uses ART TO DISPLAY the deaf experience & how the format/PROVENANCE of his material INFORMS THAT. The very IDEA OF CONVERSATIONS IS ALMOST interrogated w/ HOW GRIGELY GOES THROUGH the WORLD. BY MAKING COMMUNICATION AN INHERENT ARCHIVE & BY SUBVERTING READING PRACTICES. LOOKING AT THE WORK IS NON-LINEAR & [redacted] IMPOSSIBLE TO PARSE W/O CONTEXT, ~~almost~~ giving the PERSON W/ the disability power because he's the one w/ CONTEXT.

PERSONAL REFLECTION ON the text?

- NOT the angle I was thinking of when

e I CAN PLAY W/

ng

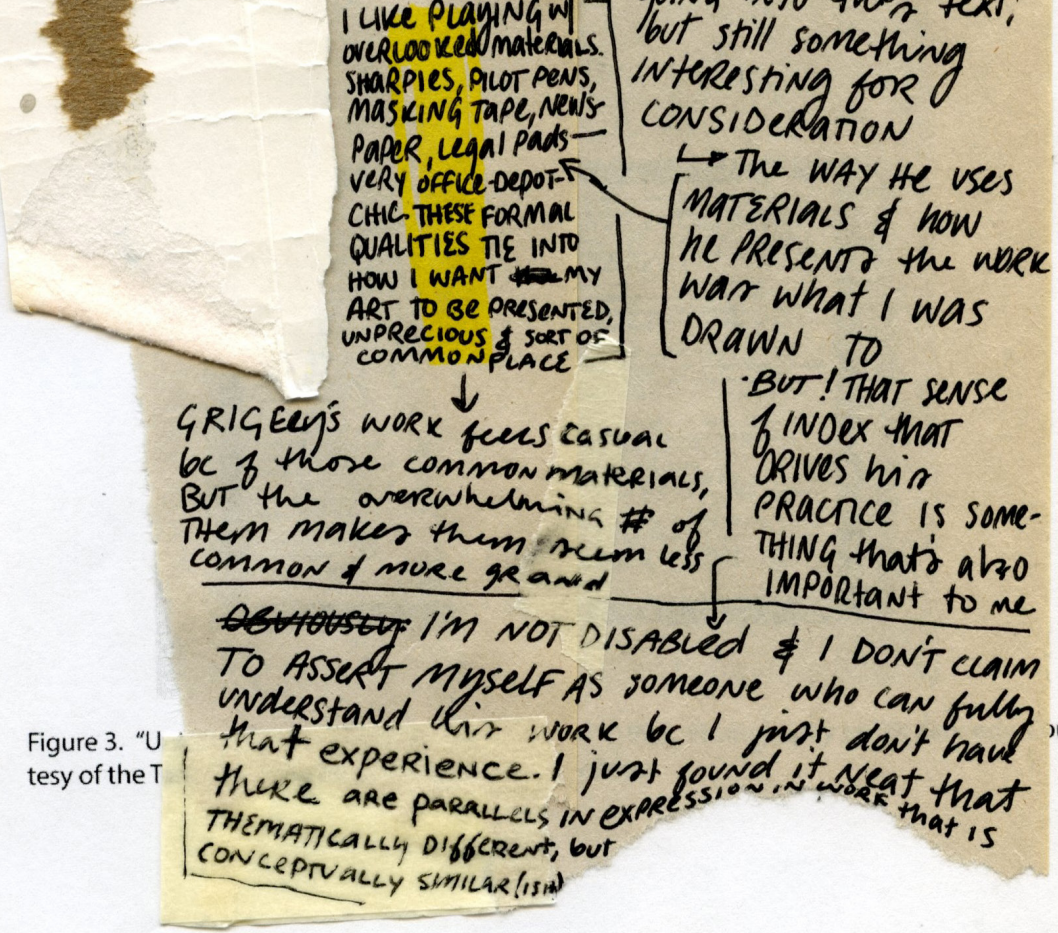


Figure 3. "U ...our-
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The art of indexing

Edward Cook

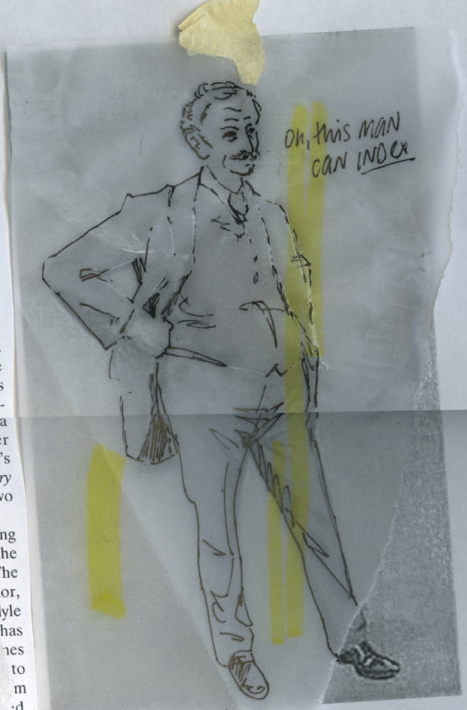
A servant with this clause
Makes drudgery divine:
Who sweeps a room as for thy laws
Makes that and th'action fine.

There is no book (in the category of general literature ...nary good that it is not made better by an index, and no book of two bad that it may not by this adjunct escape the worst condemnation. Carlyle, the foe of Dryasdust, reserved his heaviest fire for those members of the species who had not ... the decency to index themselves. He gives a list of books ... The beginning of his *Cromwell:* 'Enormous folios, these ... thor, many others have been printed, and some of them ag... rlyle printed, but never yet edited – edited as you edit wage... has loads of broken bricks and dry mortar, simply by tumbli... nes up the wagon. Not one of those monstrous old volumes h... to so much as an available Index!' And again at the beginni... m of his *Friedrich:*

Books born mostly of Chaos, which want all things, ev... an index, are a painful object .... The Prussian Dry... dust, otherwise an honest fellow and not afraid of labo... excels all other Dryasdusts yet known .... He writes ... books wanting in almost every quality; and does not ev... give an Index to them. Enough: he could do no other: ... have striven to forgive him.

The strife was hard and not, I imagine, successful, for Carlyle is credited with the saying that a publisher who issues a book without an index should be hanged. The Roxburghe Club, thinking that trial should precede execution, proposed that the omission of an Index, 'when essential,' should be an indictable offence, and Lord Campbell, in a more practical

BARS



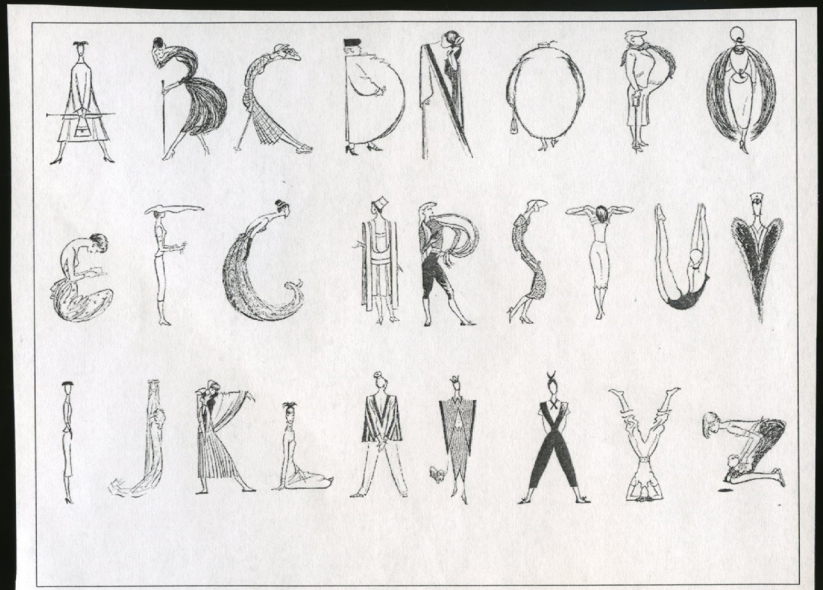
...appeared in *Vanity*
...sourced from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Edward_Tyas_Cook

have to collate passages scattered in many different essays, and there is no index to help you in the search.

The late Lord Coleridge, in a Prefatory Note to the second ... *Essays in Criticism*, says that Arnold intended to ... more about Shelley. Lord Coleridge added, ...at 'in order to gather the mind of Mr ...ny subject it is necessary to read

SIR EDWARD COOK (1857-1919) WAS AN ENGLISH EDITOR AND WRITER, PROMINENT ENOUGH TO HAVE A BIOGRAPHY WRIT... ABOUT HIM IN 1921, 2 YEARS AFTER HE DIED (THANK YOU). SAXON MILLS FOR THE RECORD). E... CATED @ OXFORD, HE WAS A PROMINENT LOND... JOURNALIST. HE WAS EDITOR OF THE Pall Mall Gaze... WESTMINSTER GAZETTE, & DAILY NEWS. OVER... SEEMED TO BE QUALIFIED ON THE SUBJEC...

the year after ... ESSA...

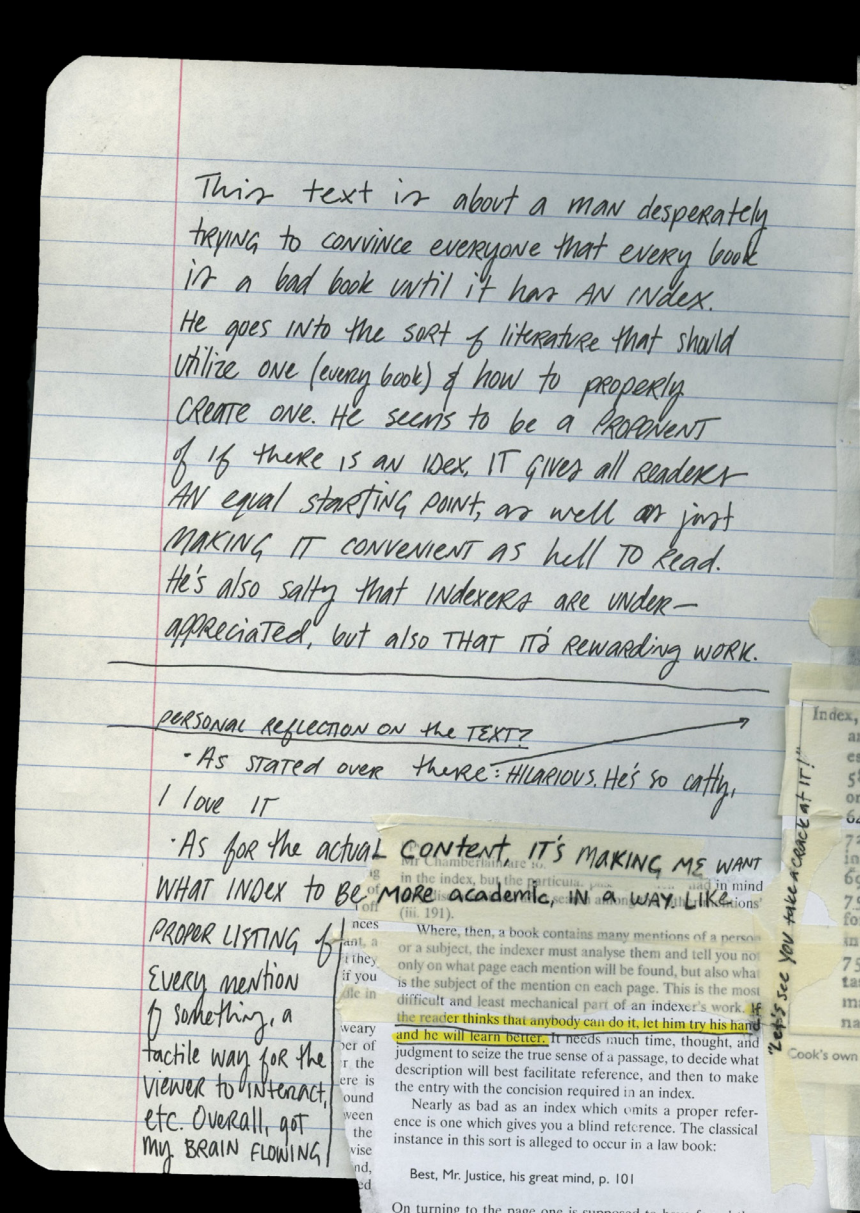


Top right, *Punch*'s take on indexing and filing; above, a *Punch* alphabet by D. L. Mays, March 1955. Both published in *The Indexer* in October 2007, and reproduced by kind permission of *Punch*.

This text is about a man desperately trying to convince everyone that every book is a bad book until it has AN INDEX. He goes into the SORT of literature that should utilize one (every book) & how to properly CREATE one. He seems to be a PROPONENT of if there is an IDEX, IT gives all readers AN equal starting point, as well as just MAKING IT CONVENIENT AS hell TO read. He's also salty that INDEXERS are under-appreciated, but also THAT IT'S REWARDING WORK.

PERSONAL REFLECTION ON the TEXT?

- As stated over there: HILARIOUS. He's so catty, I love IT
- As for the actual CONTENT, IT'S MAKING ME WANT WHAT INDEX to BE. MORE academic, IN A WAY. LIKE PROPER LISTING of Every mention of something, a tactile way for the viewer to interact, etc. Overall, got my BRAIN FLOWING



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"Let's see you take a crack at it!"

Cook's own index

Mr Chamberlain are to ... in the index, but the particula... in mind ... (iii. 191).

Where, then, a book contains many mentions of a perso... or a subject, the indexer must analyse them and tell you not only on what page each mention will be found, but also what is the subject of the mention on each page. This is the most difficult and least mechanical part of an indexer's work. If the reader thinks that anybody can do it, let him try his hand and he will learn better. It needs much time, thought, and judgment to seize the true sense of a passage, to decide what description will best facilitate reference, and then to make the entry with the concision required in an index.

Nearly as bad as an index which omits a proper reference is one which gives you a blind reference. The classical instance in this sort is alleged to occur in a law book:

Best, Mr. Justice, his great mind, p. 101

On turning to the page one is supposed to have found the

...uk by Rutgers University on November 19, 2025.
...thout permission from the rightsholder.

collaboration.

one of the minor literary arts.

There was a time when indexers had a certain status.

universities, translators and indexmakers in ragged coats of frieze.' It is better to have your ragged coat noticed than not to be noticed at all. How seldom it is in modern books that the name of the index-maker is given! I should like to believe that whenever nothing is stated to the contrary the author has made the index himself. But a bitter cry wh

HE'S SO SAD :: WE USED TO BE A COUNTRY FR (i'm pretty sure he's British)

edited modern authors would not have done better service by indexing than by 'introducing' them.

A friend of Francis Douce, the antiquary, had a curse of his own for those who sent out a book without an index where one was obviously wanted. He damned them 'ten miles beyond Hell.' For my part I think that simple damnation is enough in the case of a single book, and that the extra ten miles of Douce's friend might be reserved for those who collect an author's works without indexing them.

A specious defence against indexes has sometimes been made out of the argument that only one ought

WHY IS THIS THE FUNNIEST THING I'VE EVER READ? even the guy he's quoting is hilarious

an author to worthy of

Thomas Fuller long ago disposed of such pretence in a passage of sound sense and quaint humour:

"An index is a necessary implement, and no impediment of a book, except in the same sense wherein the carriages of an army are termed impedimenta. Without this, a large author is but a labyrinth without a clue to direct the reader therein. I confess there is a lazy kind of learning which is only indical; when scholars (like adders which only bite the horse's heels) nibble but at the tables, which are caices librerum, neglecting the body of the book. But though the idle deserve no crutches (let not a staff be used by them, but on them), pity it is the weary should be denied the benefit thereof, and industrious scholars prohibited the accommodation of an index, most used by those who most pretend to contemn it."

it be granted, then, that

exing, an art, 56, 68; dispensable adjunct, 55; lly to Collected Works, rinciples of:—one book ndex, 63, many titles, how to be arranged, 66- propaganda, 69; humour ; impartiality in, 66, ains and pleasures of, punishments proposed ission of, 56, 61, plea ce, 61; saves foot-notes, ale of, 74; use of, in books, 75; who should 72; makers to be 73

on 'index' AN INDEX ON 'INDEX'? HILARIOUS. UNIRONICALLY

Conclusion

The sources selected mirror and inform my practice by exploring the ideas I want to articulate in ways I had not considered. Most of the sources I researched were on themes I was interested in but didn't necessarily connect it directly to art in the way I was thinking. Despite that, they made me think about how to utilize those ideas in my art in different ways—like indexing in more of a real academic sense, or archives as a physical space. Because of that, I now feel as though I am considering my art in a more layered way than I had previously.

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Kelly Gomez 2025


XVIII.